

MANTA

One continuous ribbon. One gesture.

Cut like a baguette so it can be printed at home and still hold an adult.



■ IDEA

MANTA is a single thick ribbon: floor, dished seat, cantilevered backrest, forward-curved crown, tail-brace, back to the floor — no separate legs, no frame, no visible assembly. The name is literal: forked feet read as fins, the tail-brace as a fluke. The ocean makes most of the oxygen we breathe, and the manta ray is one of its health indicators — so the surface carries the story too: flutes that follow the ribbon's own motion, bold at the floor and easing toward the crown, capped where you sit so they never press into a bone.

■ BIOMIMICRY AS STRUCTURE, NOT ORNAMENT

Each rule sets the section, and each carries load:

- **Wolff's law** — thickness follows the bending moment: 84 mm at the lumbar knot, 50 mm at the knee, a 32 mm blade at the crown.
- **Murray's law** — the lumbar, the one true junction, is the cube-root-sum of seat, backrest and tail; every transition filleted.
- **Spiral fibre** — the flutes follow the stress path and stiffen by corrugation; the section twists up to 20° through the backrest.
- **Shell curvature** — the closed superelliptical section and dished seat carry load in membrane action.
- **Fiddlehead scroll** — the forward-curved crown closes the backrest into a tube, not an open cantilever.
- **Buttress roots** — each foot forks into two splayed prongs.

■ PRINTING

41 segments (each $\leq 212 \times 220 \times 250$ mm), auto-oriented for the least support: **almost support-free**, under 1 % of the filament (PrusaSlicer), none inside the holes — each is shaped for the way its part lies. PETG, 0.2 mm layers, 5 perimeters, 35 % gyroid, solid pins. ~17 kg, ~470 h on one printer, ~90 €.

■ ASSEMBLY — COMPUTED JOINTS, NO SCREWS

Cuts and joints are computed, not drawn by hand. The script slices the ribbon **crosswise** by length and curvature, keeping every cut ≥ 70 mm from the knee and lumbar where bending peaks, so those knots sit whole, mid-segment. Every joint is a full solid cross-section (7,000–17,000 mm²), epoxied, with a self-centring conical peg sized to the local thickness, centred on its face, shrunk until its socket keeps a 2 mm wall. Wide segments split along a flute-hidden keel. Only the two most-loaded lumbar joints add a solid Ø11 pin. Every part's number is engraved on a glue face. A virtual assembly verifies every peg seats in its neighbour.

■ STABILITY AND LOAD

First-order check (120 kg $\times$ 1.8 dynamic $\times$ 2.0 safety): every member passes; glued full-section joint 26 $\times$, weakest glued check 2.1 $\times$; with no glue at all, peg and pin still carry 0.9 $\times$. Tipping 0.56 sideways, 0.55–0.77 rearward; safe static load ~250 kg. Seat 429 $\times$ 364 mm, 428 mm high; 8/8 ergonomics checks pass.

~250 kg

safe static load

26 $\times$

glued full-section joint

~17 kg

finished weight

~90 €

filament cost

■ OPEN DESIGN — NOTHING REPEATS

Nothing in nature repeats, so no two parts here do either: all 41 segments are geometrically unique (script-verified). Change the tables and the same script regenerates a leaner chair, joints and load checks included; a 70 kg, half-filament variant is in the repo (anonymised source link below).